

FIRST WORLD WAR AND AFTERMATH

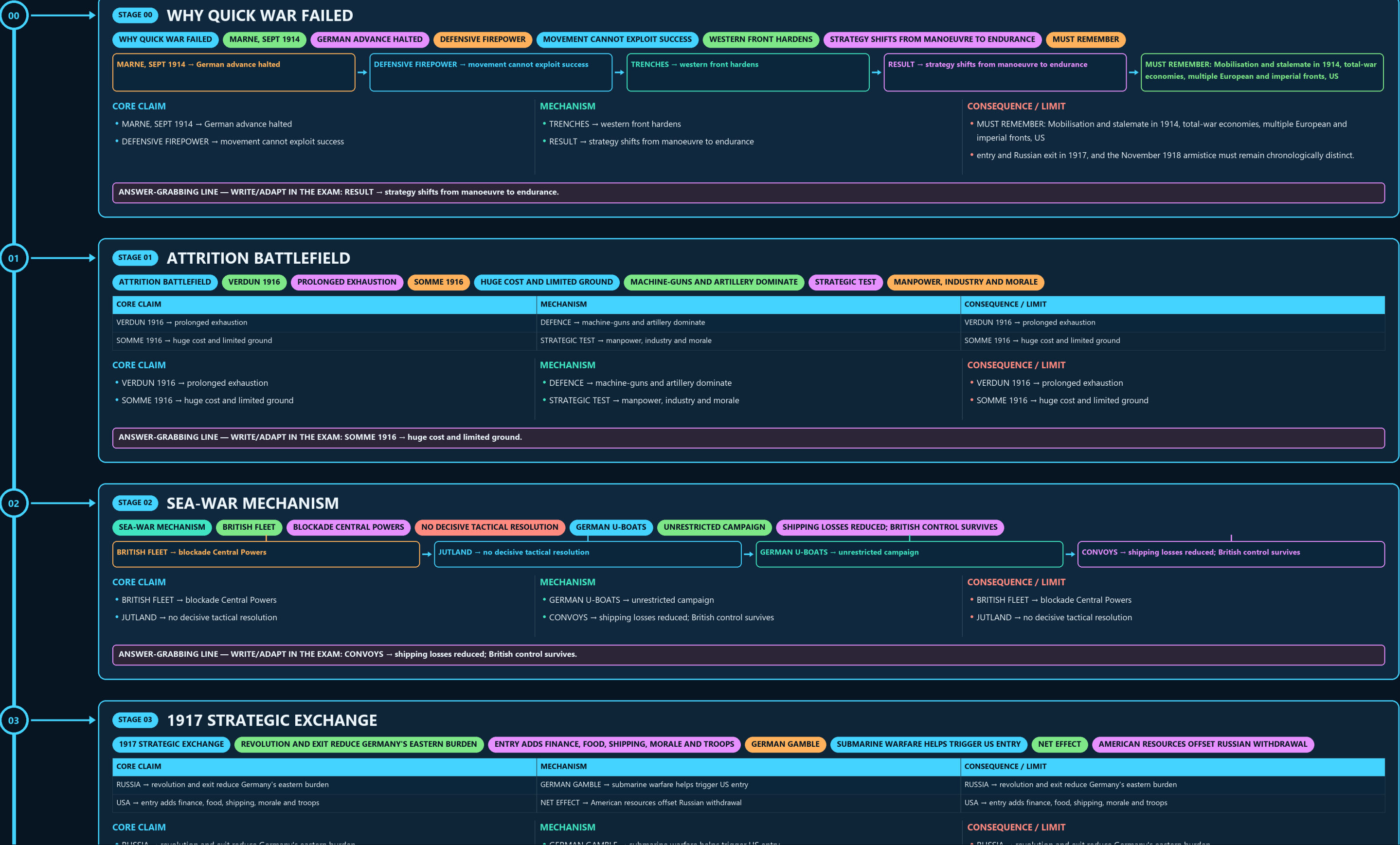
WHY QUICK WAR FAILED → ATTRITION BATTLEFIELD → SEA-WAR MECHANISM → 1917 STRATEGIC EXCHANGE → HOW THE CENTRAL POWERS → TOTAL-WAR SOCIETY

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

JUTLAND → no decisive tactical resolution

CONVOYS → shipping losses reduced; British control survives

JUTLAND → no decisive tactical resolution

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONVOYS → shipping losses reduced; British control survives.

03

STAGE 031917 STRATEGIC EXCHANGE

1917 STRATEGIC EXCHANGE

REVOLUTION AND EXIT REDUCE GERMANY'S EASTERN BURDEN

ENTRY ADDS FINANCE, FOOD, SHIPPING, MORALE AND TROOPS

GERMAN GAMBLE

SUBMARINE WARFARE HELPS TRIGGER US ENTRY

NET EFFECT

AMERICAN RESOURCES OFFSET RUSSIAN WITHDRAWAL

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RUSSIA → revolution and exit reduce Germany's eastern burden	GERMAN GAMBLE → submarine warfare helps trigger US entry	RUSSIA → revolution and exit reduce Germany's eastern burden
USA → entry adds finance, food, shipping, morale and troops	NET EFFECT → American resources offset Russian withdrawal	USA → entry adds finance, food, shipping, morale and troops

CORE CLAIM

- RUSSIA → revolution and exit reduce Germany's eastern burden
- USA → entry adds finance, food, shipping, morale and troops

MECHANISM

- GERMAN GAMBLE → submarine warfare helps trigger US entry
- NET EFFECT → American resources offset Russian withdrawal

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RUSSIA → revolution and exit reduce Germany's eastern burden
- USA → entry adds finance, food, shipping, morale and troops

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NET EFFECT → American resources offset Russian withdrawal.

04

STAGE 04HOW THE CENTRAL POWERS LOST

HOW THE CENTRAL POWERS LOST

TWO FRONTS

GERMANY'S STRUCTURAL BURDEN

SUPPLIES AND CIVILIAN ENDURANCE WEAKEN

1918 OFFENSIVE

LUDENDORFF FAILS

ALLIES COLLAPSE

BULGARIA, HABSBURG AND OTTOMAN SYSTEMS FALL

TWO FRONTS → Germany's structural burden

BLOCKADE → supplies and civilian endurance weaken

1918 OFFENSIVE → Ludendorff fails

ALLIES COLLAPSE → Bulgaria, Habsburg and Ottoman systems fall

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
TWO FRONTS → Germany's structural burden	1918 OFFENSIVE → Ludendorff fails	TWO FRONTS → Germany's structural burden
BLOCKADE → supplies and civilian endurance weaken	ALLIES COLLAPSE → Bulgaria, Habsburg and Ottoman systems fall	BLOCKADE → supplies and civilian endurance weaken

CORE CLAIM

- TWO FRONTS → Germany's structural burden
- BLOCKADE → supplies and civilian endurance weaken

MECHANISM

- 1918 OFFENSIVE → Ludendorff fails
- ALLIES COLLAPSE → Bulgaria, Habsburg and Ottoman systems fall

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TWO FRONTS → Germany's structural burden
- BLOCKADE → supplies and civilian endurance weaken

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ALLIES COLLAPSE → Bulgaria, Habsburg and Ottoman systems fall.

05

STAGE 05TOTAL-WAR SOCIETY

TOTAL-WAR SOCIETY

CONTROLS INDUSTRY, TRANSPORT AND FOOD

ENTER EXPANDED WARTIME PRODUCTION ROLES

BLOCKADE AND PROPAGANDA MAKE HOME FRONT STRATEGIC

COLONIAL MANPOWER AND TERRITORY GLOBALISE THE WAR

STATE → controls industry, transport and food

WOMEN → enter expanded wartime production roles

CIVILIANS → blockade and propaganda make home front strategic

EMPIRE → colonial manpower and territory globalise the war

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
STATE → controls industry, transport and food	CIVILIANS → blockade and propaganda make home front strategic	STATE → controls industry, transport and food
WOMEN → enter expanded wartime production roles	EMPIRE → colonial manpower and territory globalise the war	WOMEN → enter expanded wartime production roles

CORE CLAIM

- STATE → controls industry, transport and food
- WOMEN → enter expanded wartime production roles

MECHANISM

- CIVILIANS → blockade and propaganda make home front strategic
- EMPIRE → colonial manpower and territory globalise the war

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- STATE → controls industry, transport and food
- WOMEN → enter expanded wartime production roles

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EMPIRE → colonial manpower and territory globalise the war.

06

STAGE 06POLITICAL EARTHQUAKE

POLITICAL EARTHQUAKE

BOLSHEVIK RULE

REVOLUTION AND WEIMAR REPUBLIC

EMPIRES COLLAPSE INTO NEW ARRANGEMENTS

GLOBAL POWER

USA AND JAPAN GAIN AS EUROPE WEAKENS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule	HABSBURG/OTTOMAN → empires collapse into new arrangements	RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule
GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic	GLOBAL POWER → USA and Japan gain as Europe weakens	GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic

CORE CLAIM

- RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule
- GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic

MECHANISM

- HABSBURG/OTTOMAN → empires collapse into new arrangements
- GLOBAL POWER → USA and Japan gain as Europe weakens

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule
- GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic

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06

STAGE 06

POLITICAL EARTHQUAKE

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BOLSHEVIK RULE

REVOLUTION AND WEIMAR REPUBLIC

EMPIRES COLLAPSE INTO NEW ARRANGEMENTS

GLOBAL POWER

USA AND JAPAN GAIN AS EUROPE WEAKENS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule	HABSBURG/OTTOMAN → empires collapse into new arrangements	RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule
GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic	GLOBAL POWER → USA and Japan gain as Europe weakens	GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic

CORE CLAIM

- RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule
- GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic

MECHANISM

- HABSBURG/OTTOMAN → empires collapse into new arrangements
- GLOBAL POWER → USA and Japan gain as Europe weakens

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule
- GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GLOBAL POWER — USA and Japan gain as Europe weakens.

07

STAGE 07

FIVE-TREATY MATCHING

FIVE-TREATY MATCHING

GERMANY; ST GERMAIN

HUNGARY; NEUILLY

OTTOMAN TURKEY, REJECTED

LAUSANNE 1923

REVISED TURKISH SETTLEMENT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
VERSAILLES → Germany; ST GERMAIN → Austria	SEVRES → Ottoman Turkey, rejected	VERSAILLES → Germany; ST GERMAIN → Austria
TRIANON → Hungary; NEUILLY → Bulgaria	LAUSANNE 1923 → revised Turkish settlement	TRIANON → Hungary; NEUILLY → Bulgaria

CORE CLAIM

- VERSAILLES → Germany; ST GERMAIN → Austria
- TRIANON → Hungary; NEUILLY → Bulgaria

MECHANISM

- SEVRES → Ottoman Turkey, rejected
- LAUSANNE 1923 → revised Turkish settlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VERSAILLES → Germany; ST GERMAIN → Austria
- TRIANON → Hungary; NEUILLY → Bulgaria

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SEVRES → Ottoman Turkey, rejected; LAUSANNE 1923 → revised Turkish settlement.

08

STAGE 08

VERSAILLES CONTAINMENT

VERSAILLES CONTAINMENT

ALSACE-LORRAINE, POLAND, DANZIG, SAAR

100,000 ARMY; NO CONSCRIPTION OR KEY WEAPONS

UNION WITH GERMANY FORBIDDEN

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
TERRITORY → Alsace-Lorraine, Poland, Danzig, Saar	RHINELAND → demilitarised	TERRITORY → Alsace-Lorraine, Poland, Danzig, Saar
MILITARY → 100,000 army; no conscription or key weapons	AUSTRIA → union with Germany forbidden	MILITARY → 100,000 army; no conscription or key weapons

CORE CLAIM

- TERRITORY → Alsace-Lorraine, Poland, Danzig, Saar
- MILITARY → 100,000 army; no conscription or key weapons

MECHANISM

- RHINELAND → demilitarised
- AUSTRIA → union with Germany forbidden

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TERRITORY → Alsace-Lorraine, Poland, Danzig, Saar
- MILITARY → 100,000 army; no conscription or key weapons

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MILITARY → 100,000 army; no conscription or key weapons.

09

STAGE 09

ARTICLE 231 AND REPARATIONS

ARTICLE 231 AND REPARATIONS

ARTICLE 231

LEGAL LIABILITY FOR ALLIED LOSS AND DAMAGE

READ IN GERMANY AS WAR-GUILT CLAUSE

REPARATIONS FIXED AT £6600 MILLION

REVISIONIST GRIEVANCE PLUS ENFORCEMENT PROBLEM

CLOSE DISTINCTION

MILITARY VICTORY, ARMISTICE, PARIS PEACE TREATIES, VERSAILLES PROVISIONS AND

ARTICLE 231 → legal liability for Allied loss and damage

POLITICS → read in Germany as war-guilt clause

1921 → reparations fixed at £6600 million

EFFECT → revisionist grievance plus enforcement problem

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Military victory, armistice, Paris peace treaties, Versailles provisions and the League settlement were

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ARTICLE 231 → legal liability for Allied loss and damage	1921 → reparations fixed at £6600 million	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Military victory, armistice, Paris peace treaties, Versailles provisions and the League settlement were separate stages
POLITICS → read in Germany as war-guilt clause	EFFECT → revisionist grievance plus enforcement problem	treaty grievance neither explains the whole war nor makes a second war automatic.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Military victory, armistice, Paris peace treaties, Versailles provisions and the League settlement were separate stages; treaty grievance neither explains the whole war nor makes a second war automatic.

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09

STAGE 09

ARTICLE 231 AND REPARATIONS

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LEGAL LIABILITY FOR ALLIED LOSS AND DAMAGE

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CORE CLAIM

ARTICLE 231 → legal liability for Allied loss and damage

POLITICS → read in Germany as war-guilt clause

MECHANISM

1921 → reparations fixed at £6600 million

EFFECT → revisionist grievance plus enforcement problem

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Military victory, armistice, Paris peace treaties, Versailles provisions and the League settlement were separate stages

treaty grievance neither explains the whole war nor makes a second war automatic.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Military victory, armistice, Paris peace treaties, Versailles provisions and the League settlement were separate stages; treaty grievance neither explains the whole war nor makes a second war automatic.

10

STAGE 10

MANDATES: CHANGE AND CONTINUITY

CHANGE AND CONTINUITY

OLD LANGUAGE

CONQUEST AND ANNEXATION

NEW LANGUAGE

LEAGUE TRUSTEESHIP AND PREPARATION FOR INDEPENDENCE

BRITAIN AND FRANCE RETAIN IMPERIAL CONTROL

EMPIRE SURVIVES UNDER CONDITIONAL JUSTIFICATION

EVIDENCE LIMIT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
OLD LANGUAGE → conquest and annexation	VERDICT → empire survives under conditional justification	German punishment alone.
NEW LANGUAGE → League trusteeship and preparation for independence	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Mass death, revolution, empire collapse, mandates, minority problems and colonial	
PRACTICE → Britain and France retain imperial control	mobilisation remade the world beyond Europe, so aftermath cannot be reduced to	

CORE CLAIM

OLD LANGUAGE → conquest and annexation

NEW LANGUAGE → League trusteeship and preparation for independence

PRACTICE → Britain and France retain imperial control

MECHANISM

VERDICT → empire survives under conditional justification

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Mass death, revolution, empire collapse, mandates, minority problems and colonial

mobilisation remade the world beyond Europe, so aftermath cannot be reduced to

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

German punishment alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Mass death, revolution, empire collapse, mandates, minority problems and colonial mobilisation remade the world beyond Europe, so aftermath cannot be reduced to.

11

STAGE 11

WAR-AND-PEACE ANSWER SPINE

WAR-AND-PEACE ANSWER SPINE

FAILED QUICK WAR, ATTRITION, BLOCKADE AND COALITION COLLAPSE

TOTAL WAR

STATE, SOCIETY, WOMEN, CIVILIANS AND EMPIRE

TREATY CLUSTER, LEAGUE, MANDATES AND MINORITIES

POLITICAL EARTHQUAKE FOLLOWED BY UNSTABLE PEACE

COURSE → failed quick war, attrition, blockade and coalition collapse

TOTAL WAR → state, society, women, civilians and empire

SETTLEMENT → treaty cluster, League, mandates and minorities

VERDICT → political earthquake followed by unstable peace

CORE CLAIM

COURSE → failed quick war, attrition, blockade and coalition collapse

TOTAL WAR → state, society, women, civilians and empire

MECHANISM

SETTLEMENT → treaty cluster, League, mandates and minorities

VERDICT → political earthquake followed by unstable peace

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

COURSE → failed quick war, attrition, blockade and coalition collapse

TOTAL WAR → state, society, women, civilians and empire

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → political earthquake followed by unstable peace.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

TANKS, SUBMARINES, BOMBERS, MACHINE-GUNS, HEAVY ARTILLERY AND GAS CHANGED

WOMEN ENTERED FACTORY AND OTHER WARTIME ROLES ON A

WHOLE SOCIETIES WERE MOBILIZED

BLOCKADE HARDSHIP HIT CIVILIANS, ESPECIALLY IN THE CENTRAL POWERS

DICTATED PEACE WITHOUT GERMAN PARTICIPATION

TERRITORIAL LOSSES, ESPECIALLY WHERE GERMANS REMAINED OUTSIDE THE REICH

ARTICLE 231, READ IN GERMANY AS A WAR-GUILT CLAUSE

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

tanks, submarines, bombers, machine-guns, heavy artillery and gas changed warfare;

women entered factory and other wartime roles on a much larger scale;

whole societies were mobilized;

blockade hardship hit civilians, especially in the Central Powers and Russia.

ADVANCED DEBATE

dictated peace without German participation;

territorial losses, especially where Germans remained outside the Reich;

Article 231, read in Germany as a war-guilt clause and used by the Allies as a legal basis for reparations;

reparations set at £6600 million.

LEGACY / NUANCE

some territorial changes were defensible on nationality grounds;

many terms broadly reflected Wilsonian ideas plus later wartime hardening;

Germany had itself imposed Brest-Litovsk harshly on Russia.

Europe was split between revisionist states and status-quo states;

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.